GURUSPEAK

> "Our continuous endeavour is to create a holistic environment where ideas can flourish and students, researchers and faculties can work to the best of their potential"

PROF. ABHAY KARANDIKAR
DIRECTOR, IIT-KANPUR

solve problems that challenge humanity. Small individual-led groups spearhead research at IIT-K and there are also large interdisciplinary project teams.

The institute has a unique e-master's programme for working professionals. This year, updated courses on Communication Systems, and Quantitative Finance and Risk Management, were launched, catering to the emerging trends in 5G and 6G domains, and the finance industry, respectively.

EndureAir, a startup founded by the Department of Aerospace Engineering, is revolutionising the drone industry, with their Vibhram and ORBIT drones.

The Med-tech Department, set up under the Centre's Make in India initiative in 2019, makes innovative medical equipment for the healthcare sector.

The institute was the first to award SSI (self-sovereign identity)-enabled blockchain digital degrees to students last year. It was developed by CRUBN, a startup founded under the National Blockchain Project. The same technology was later used by several state governments for securing digital records, and by the ministry of women and child development for distributing certificates to the awardees of the Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar, 2022. ■

by Prashant Srivastava

NO. 3 **INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY BOMBAY**
Mumbai

CLASS OF ITS OWN

When Mumbai was a hot spot during the Covid-19 pandemic, IIT-Bombay (IIT-B) came as a saviour with its world-class research. The institute developed technologies for the identification of global metabolite biomarkers in patients for targeted therapy and an incineration device for the safe disposal of masks/ gloves. Their mobile app, CORONTINE, for tracking/tracing asymptomatic carriers, was adopted in Odisha and Meghalaya, and partly by the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC).

IIT-B developed an algorithmic protocol for pooled RT-PCR testing of samples and validated using clinical samples at various hospitals in Mumbai and Bengaluru. Its CoviDialysis portal was adopted by BMC for effective hemodialysis patient management.

Besides the health sector, IIT-B research also helped industries and businessmen. Its e-commerce software platform 'Lokacart' connected sellers and consumers to reduce the waiting period to buy essential items.

On the academics front in 2020-21, IIT-B introduced several postgraduate programmes in urban development, management, engineering and finance. It carried out 246 R&D-sponsored and 538 consultancy projects. The number of students graduating with PhD has gone up from 180 in 2010-11 to 381 in 2020-21.

IIT-B researchers filed 263 applications for intellectual properties in 2020-21. Around 225 industries from India and abroad approached the institute for collaborative R&D projects and consultancy services. As for placements, 570 companies registered on its job portal. The number of registered students increased by 11 per cent compared to the previous year. The salaries are four-five times the average entry-level engineering package offered to students of other colleges in India. ■

by Kiran D. Tare

GURUSPEAK

> "We strive to provide the best career training for our students and focus on research and activities that have greater impact on our society"

PROF. SUBHASIS CHAUDHURI
DIRECTOR, IIT-B

ALUMNISPEAK

> "The faculty allowed, and sometimes insisted, students think on their own, and brought the best out of them, which is fundamental to the career growth of the student."

DR K. SIVAN
FORMER CHAIRMAN, ISRO